Mammals

There are three types of mammals: **placental** mammals, **marsupials** and **monotremes**.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to fill out the passage below.

Word bank					
three	milk	eggs	inside	mammal	pouch
mammary	placenta	marsupials	nipple	drinks	grow

Mammals drink m_____ when they are born. The word 'm_____' comes from the term 'mammary gland', which is the tissue that produces milk. There are t_____ types of mammals. Most mammals are placental. They develop i_____ the mother's uterus and are nourished by the p_____, a special organ that the mother produces. When the mammal is born it is well developed and d_____ from the mother's nipples.

When m_____ are born they are tiny, under-developed and skinny. They crawl along the mother's fur until they reach her p_____. They hide inside and attach themselves to the mother's n_____. They drink plenty of milk and g_____ big and strong inside the pouch.

Monotremes develop inside e_____. When the eggs hatch the babies lick milk from the mother's m_____ glands on her belly.

2 Put the following mammals into the correct groups in the table:

koala echidna dog sheep platypus kangaroo

Placental mammals	Marsupials	Monotremes

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